

TIMELINE

- **c.1820** Born Araminta "Minty" Ross in Dorchester County, Maryland, to enslaved parents Harriet "Rit" Green and Ben Ross.
- **1834** Struck on head by an iron weight, which causes serious side effects for the rest of her life.
- **1844** Marries freedman John Tubman. Takes the first name of "Harriet."
- **1849** Runs away from slavery in the late fall after hearing rumors she might be sold.
- **1850** Fugitive Slave Act passed. Tubman conducts her niece and niece's two children to freedom in the North.
- **1851-52** Conducts other enslaved people, including her brother Moses, from the Eastern Shore of Maryland to freedom. Her husband John, who has remarried, refuses to relocate North.
- **1854-60** Makes many trips to the Eastern Shore, personally guiding hundreds to freedom; comes to the attention of the leading abolitionists during this time.
- **1858** Meets John Brown at her home in St. Catharines, Ontario, Canada. Confers on, but does not participate in, the Harpers Ferry raid.
- **1859** Lectures in New England about her work on the Underground Railroad.
- **1862-65** Works in an unofficial but valuable capacity for the Union forces at Hilton Head, South Carolina, as a nurse, cook, and scout.
- **1863** Along with Colonel James Montgomery, Tubman co-leads the Combahee River Raid on June 2, in which 700 enslaved people are liberated and critical Confederate supplies are burned.
- **1865** Nurses wounded soldiers at Fortress Monroe, Virginia.
- **1869** Marries Civil War veteran Nelson Davis.
- **1870-90** Farms her small property in Auburn, New York, and engages in small enterprises, most of which do not prosper. Supports former enslaved people and the destitute.
- **1888** Nelson Davis dies.